

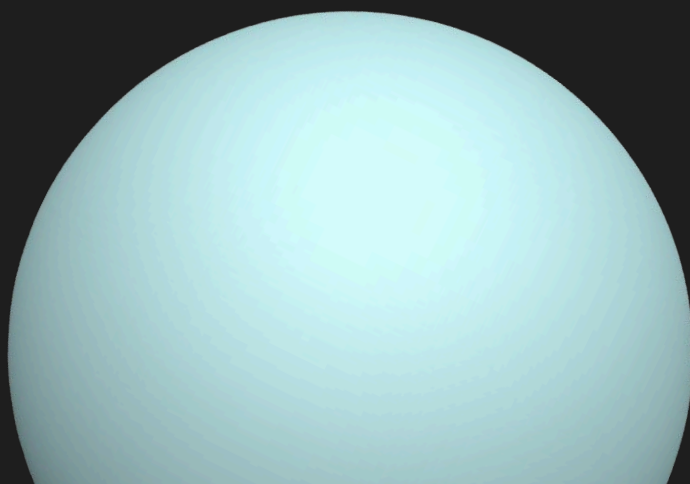
The
Wabi-Sabi
Website
Blueprint



A Curated, 15-video
Voyage for Local
Businesses to Launch
their Digital Presence
From Scratch

Table of Contents

Introduction	3
Brand Strategy	4
Web Design	7
Web Development	11
How did you do?	15
How did I do?	16



First off, you should be proud of yourself for taking that first step into building your own website!

I will let you know right now, that this isn't going to be an easy journey! Making a website feels like staring at the paper when you can't write something, sometimes it still is that way for me!

This guide will help you lay out the foundational work that will take you from ideas, to visuals, to a full website! And if you need any help, you can always book a free consultation call with me using this link!

I call it the Wabi-Sabi Website Blueprint, as it may not be the perfect, but we can embrace the imperfections and own them on your journey to building this perfectly imperfect website.

Without further ado, let's get into it!



Brand strategy is the more analytical approach that takes place before any design or development happens. It's not flashy, but it's the foundation that will take place for the flashiness. A website that is elegant, minimal, and cool is nothing more than a vague description. Do we use serif or sans-serif or both or neither? Are we using earth tones, or a monochromatic color theme? These are the questions we figure out in this phase.

The background features a large, dark grey curved shape on the left side. A horizontal grey brushstroke is positioned in the upper right area. In the bottom right corner, there is a bright green sphere.

Brand Strategy

Brand Strategy For Designers: How to Get Started (Part 1)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tgDjT6G5VZo>

This video summarizes what **thefutur** talks about within all their brand strategy videos. There are too many golden nuggets of information in this video, and you can see how brand strategy can be applied to many things more than just websites! You learn what a brand truly is, and how it is perceived in the mind. Warning: there's nothing actionable in this video. However there's a reason why I put this video first. It puts you (or at least it put me) in the mindset of what a brand is and how I want to start translating that feeling of my brand into people.

Building A Brand – Defining The Customer, Episode 2

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fZD-IFIKb68>

This video shows **thefutur**'s team in the process of the discovery session/brand strategy. I want you to be in the shoes of Josh and Crysten: see the passion they have for their business and why they started it. That should reflect the reason for the brand strategy, and later influence the design. However, you should also try and put yourself in the shoes of Ben and Matthew as well: the tiniest questions give away the biggest details that unveil the clearest answers to your brand strategy (hint: 10:51).



Learn Brand Strategy In 17 Minutes (101 Crash Course)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VrwBu8DYWkE>

This video by **Brand Master Academy** outlines a very detailed guide on what to include in your brand strategy. In my opinion, it's actually a little too in-depth, not that there's anything wrong with that. Brand archetype is something I've never heard of and never used, and don't think it's necessary. In any case, really take in how these steps can build a strong strategy that will influence the look and feel of the brand, and create the ultimate foundation that will create the next logical step to how this website will look!

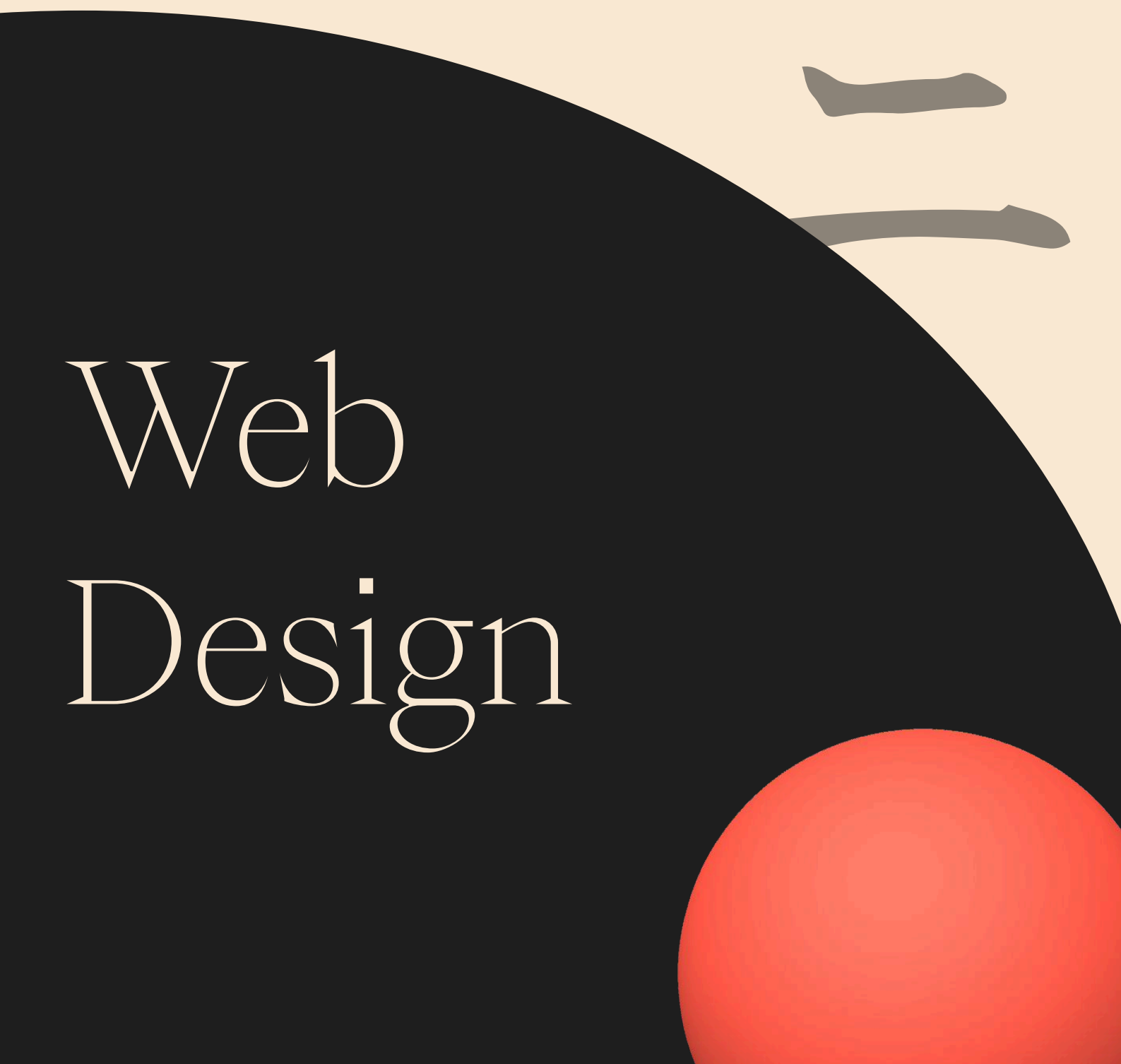
Brand Identity Design Process - Airline Branding Challenge - Young Guns EP 9

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NOWD9KG7kEY>

Critique is something you are going to have little of when starting this process (unless you book that consultation call!). But listen to how **Chris Do** tries to educate the students within this competition, as this will give you insight on how you can refine your brand strategy into something even better. To this day, I still watch this video to ensure I'm doing everything right. I also always reference how Sharif grouped his keywords of the brand into categories, it's a great way to understand the brand at hand!



You've mapped out your brand strategy, crucial to any marketing collateral you create, and especially crucial to building your website. Now it's time to actually start taking the research you have accumulated, and transform them into the content, the visual look, and the layout of your dream perfectly-imperfect website!



Web Design

Building A Client Website From Scratch – Building A Brand, Episode 8

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LZtM7wyqe7w>

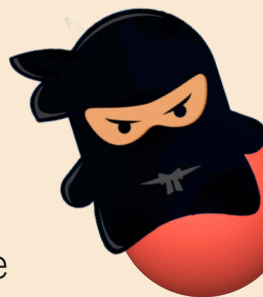
To give you an overview of how the web design and development process could look like, we're going back to **thefutur**'s Building a Brand series. In this episode, they build a website from scratch and it will show you exactly the different thought processes that go into creating the website! There are also some great tips on what makes a great website, so take some notes and enjoy!



How To Write Website Copy That Converts (and ISN'T Boring)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5aGXDx8kqww>

Before you start laying out or thinking about designing, we have to draft out what the content is going to be in your website! This video helped me break down exactly where to start, how to organize the information, and how to refine the content for any website! Btw, the Hemingway app mentioned is such a good tool to use and I always use it when I write my content! And to go from that six-item checklist, I want you to get a grasp of how many pages you want in your website, and use the checklist to guide you through the copy of each website!



How to Properly Layout A Website (For Beginners)

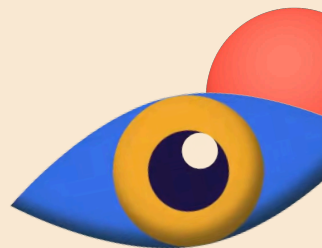
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3C_22eBWpjg

This video by **The Website Architect** will help you take all that content that you wrote and start laying out a website through structuring the content, and paring it down to the exact layout that will make the block of text feel like a cohesive web experience! This video is great as it breaks down in a very easy-to-follow process how to take content and turn it into sections for your website! Hopefully this also gets you thinking about what images you want to use for your website as well, images are so vital to any website!

Graphic Design Basics | FREE COURSE

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fZD-IFIKb68>

Now you might think, “whoa, I’m not a graphic designer.” True dat, however web design and graphic design go hand in hand, and this video gives you the basic principles of design that will help you to understand how something is designed and how you can visually communicate the exact brand strategy you created in the first section! Now this goes super in-depth, do you need to know what a ligature or descender in typefaces are? No! But watch the video at 2x speed, and write down what you think is most important! Btw, please don’t use dafont.com for fonts. Anyone can upload fonts on there which means you might get poor quality fonts. I recommend instead to go on Behance (create an account with Google) and searching for free fonts there!



Designing a Personal Portfolio Website–Web Design Process: Built By Hand Ep 3

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NKgoyLeigtU>

Warning: this is now a how-to-design video. This is a video hoping to give you some empathy. Ben Burns, as you've seen 3 times now, is a legendary creative director. Yet he still feels like he doesn't know what he's doing as he's designing his own website. There are some amazing golden nuggets to pull out of this that will help in designing your website, and hopefully get you excited to go through the same journey too!



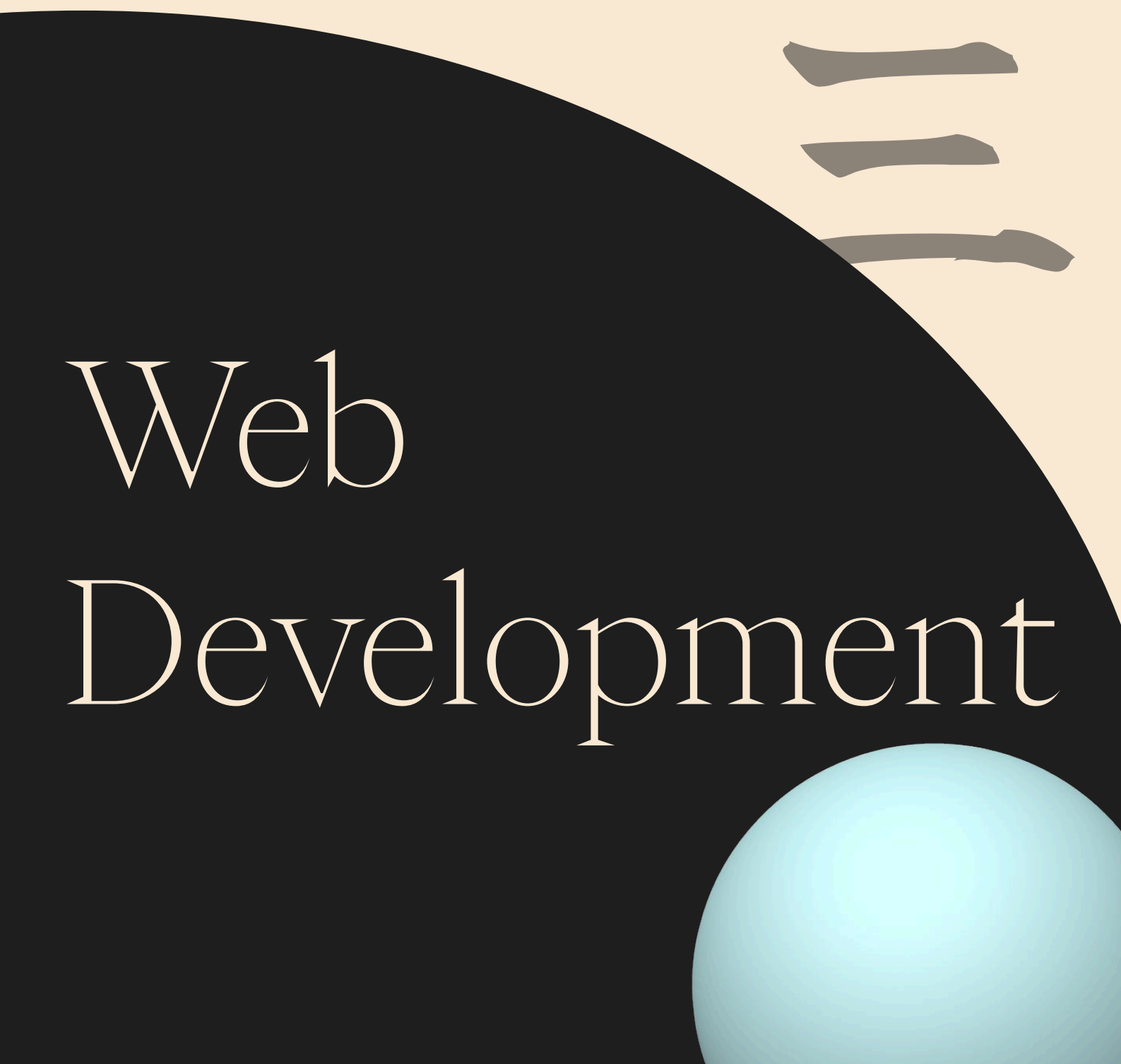
Beginner Figma Tutorial: Create a Design Portfolio Website

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q2lupOJHrzM>

This video is a quick crash course on how to use the free in-browser design tool Figma to take your designs off of the sketchbook and into a fully fledged design! Now this is just a video on how to use Figma to its full capacity. But now it's up to you to take the leap and start making your website! You can start by making just the wireframe version in Figma, and then start adding the colors, copy, and images as you go! I believe in you!



Framer, Webflow, Readymag, Squarespace, Wix, or custom code. Which one do you choose? Hopefully I can help you narrow down that choice based on how creative you were in the web design process. Custom code might be daunting, but it's actually much easier than you think now! Even just trying out a custom code approach can help you to understand how these no-code web builders work! Now if you have more of a budget, going the no-code route like using Framer or Webflow will save you more time!



Web Development

coding my first website from scratch (using only html/css!)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PcjvmYjFres>

It's always nice to feel like you have a buddy guiding you. So I thought I'd put this in as a sort of bonus video. If you want to see someone who's never done coding code up their own imperfectly perfect website, watch this for inspiration and know that everyone is still learning what to do! This person actually has coding experience through their work, but didn't go through the traditional route of getting a degree which I really like! It shows that anybody can code!



Build a Personal Website with HTML & CSS (Beginner Crash Course)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZPMtug9qExk>

Even if you're still thinking of using a no-code software, getting the grasp of basic HTML and CSS will give you a huge upper-hand in building your website from scratch, as they build off those principles. But if you are also looking to just go the full custom-code route, this will give you some scaffolding to build off and start building that dream website! This tutorial uses modern HTML and CSS techniques to get your website up and running!



How to put an HTML website online (on the Internet)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NKgoyLeigtU>

Warning: this is now a how-to-design video. This is a video hoping to give you some empathy. Ben Burns, as you've seen 3 times now, is a legendary creative director. Yet he still feels like he doesn't know what he's doing as he's designing his own website. There are some amazing golden nuggets to pull out of this that will help in designing your website, and hopefully get you excited to go through the same journey too!



I Ranked Every Website Builder [TIER LIST]

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I16w2xV4KTM>

This video is great to just get you started on what kind of web builders are out there and how they stack up to the ecosystem of web builders as a whole. There might be some you've heard and some you haven't. One of them that it doesn't mention is Readymag, which I believe is also a viable option that gives you ton of flexibility on how to build websites with that no-code feel! Now is it viable for me to put every single tutorial on every single web builder after this video? No, otherwise this document will be 40 pages long. Instead this last video is going to be what I think is the best middle of the road way whether you have a really basic layout or a complex super-customized layout. This guy may have ranked this in the B-tier, but I guarantee you this builder will help you succeed.



Build Your Portfolio Website in 50 Minutes (Framer Tutorial)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w6ZPSqvH3Yw>

Out of all the web builders, I think I gotta give it to Framer. It acts just like Figma with frames, auto-layout (stacks in Framer), and components, which means you already know how to use Framer if you used Figma! Plus, it publishes straight to the web! You still have to purchase a custom domain from somewhere like NameCheap (which I also use for my domains), but otherwise your website launches at the click of a button! Check out this tutorial that builds a sample portfolio website with simple animations, and full responsiveness.



insert your imperfectly
perfect website here



How did you do?

How far did you get through the video list? Have you started on your brand strategy? Or perhaps your website is ready to launch?

OR perhaps you're just reading through this e-book to see if this is really going to help you. If that's the case, I totally get it, honestly I would do the same thing!

This goes without saying, but it takes a lot of guts to just download this e-book. If you are reading this it means you really do want a website built for your needs, and I am so here for you, slay! You may be feeling stuck and unsure of where to start. My advice would be to just watch the first brand strategy video and the first web design video. Those two videos will really get the ideas flowing and understand the steps you need to undertake your custom website.

Remember, and this is hard for me too, inspiration and motivation comes during the work, not before it! And I'm a victim of it too. I couldn't even get back into watching Breaking Bad because my brain thought it was too overwhelming to sit down on the couch, and remember everything that happened from the past 4 seasons and the first half of season 5, in order to watch the next episode. But once I did (a.k.a my grandma forcing me too because she was watching it with me and hadn't watched it in a week beforehand), I easily got back into the swing of things to watch how Walter avoids.... Wait I don't wanna spoil it for you lol.

What I'm trying to say is, I believe in you. If you want to book a conference call with me (first two are free) to just talk through things or while you are in the process of building your website, here's a link to do so!



Also, how did I do?

Trust me I am not perfect at all. I might have more experience than some, but it doesn't make me perfect. I've sorted through a ton of videos just to get to the list that I came to. This is just a starting point, so perhaps the YouTube algorithm suggests a different Figma or Framer tutorial that is better than what I originally listed. Maybe you found another video that you think would be beneficial to the original list.

If you have some feedback in general, I would love to know what you had in mind about my guide. Was it easy to get through all those videos? Is this list too short or too long? I want to make building a website as easy as possible without you having to sort through videos yourself!

Organizing and accumulating this list has also made me realized, there isn't like a one stop shop YouTube channel for all this information. For a local artist or business owner building their custom website, they're going to have to somehow know all the steps going from brand strategy to design to development, search and sift through a ton of videos to see which ones have the right information, and then (do the work you're doing) and extract all the information from it, and build the website. Perhaps I could just make a video series that would do all that for you?

For any feedback, visit this specific form (clicking here or the button at the bottom right) within my website that will help me understand how this was helpful, what was beneficial, and any constructive criticism you may have for the future!

I would love to keep updating this so that my people have the best resource in building their dream website. Remember, it's going to be imperfect, but it will also be perfect.



Thank you!

And shoutouts to all
the people who made
these videos, we
couldn't have done it
without y'all!

